Towards **Reliable Machine Learning** for **Visual Analytics**

Hyeon Jeon, Ph.D. Student,
Dept. of Computer Science and Engineering,
Seoul National University, Seoul, Korea

hci lab
SEOUL NATIONAL UNIVERSITY



I tackle **prevalent assumptions** that makes
ML applications in visual analyatics unreliable.

I **design** and **democratize** diverse techniques for the purpose

I focus on **dimensionality reduction** and **clustering**,
two ML algorithms that are widely used for visual analytics

Reliable Algorithms

- UMATO (**VIS 2022**)

Reliable Interactions

- CLAMS (**VIS 2023**)
  Best papers honorable mention (top 5%)
- Distortion-aware brushing (**wip**)
  under review (**TVCG**)

Reliable Evaluations

- Steadiness & Cohesiveness (**VIS 2021**)
- Classes are not Clusters (**VIS 2023**)
- Adjusted IVMs (**wip**)
  under review (**TPAMI**)

Democratizing the Findings

- ZADU (**VIS 2023**)
- Structural Complexity (**wip**)
  under review (**VIS 2024**)
- Why not be reliable? (**wip**)

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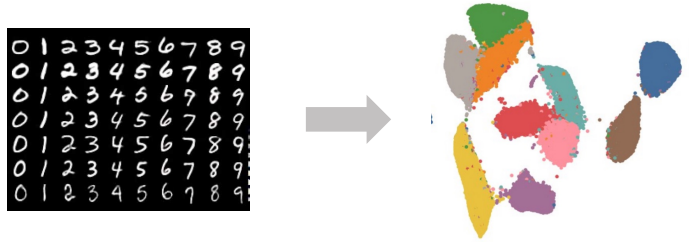
Democratizing the Findings

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  under review (**VIS 2024**)
- Why not be reliable? (**wip**)



Reliable Algorithms

UMATO IEEE VIS 2022



UMAP is widely used for **cluster analysis**

However, the technique actually focus on **neighborhood structure**, thus using it for cluster analysis is unreliable

UMATO IEEE VIS 2022



UMAP is widely used for cluster analysis

However, the technique actually focus on neighborhood structure, thus using it for cluster analysis is unreliable

I designed **UMATO,** a dimensionality reduction technique that reliably depicts both **neighborhood** and **cluster** structures

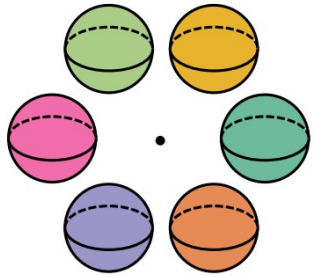




Reliable Evaluations

Class Labels are widely used as well-separated **ground truth cluster** in evaluating **dimensionality reduction** and **clustering**

However, **class labels** often do not form **clear clusters**, making evaluations using the labels **less reliable**



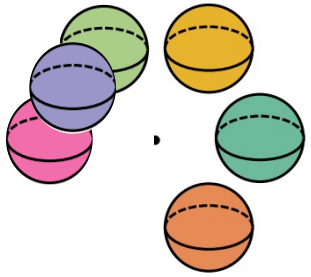
Class labels



Good embedding

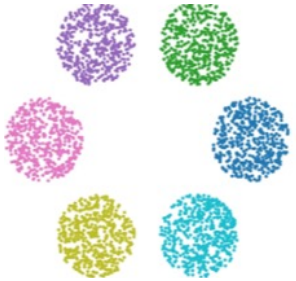


Bad embedding



Class labels

!= Ground Truth Clusters



Good embedding??







Bad embedding??

Steadiness & Cohesiveness IEEE VIS 2021

Let's **avoid using class labels!!**
Instead, let's use **clustering algorithms** to examine cluster structure

Steadiness & Cohesiveness IEEE VIS 2021

Let's **avoid using class labels!!**
Instead, let's use **clustering algorithms** to examine cluster structure

Adjusted IVMs *under review*, IEEE TPAMI

Let's check the separability of class labels
and **only use well-separated classes** as ground truth clusters

Steadiness & Cohesiveness IEEE VIS 2021

Let's **avoid using class labels!!**
Instead, let's use **clustering algorithms** to examine cluster structure

Adjusted IVMs *under review*, IEEE TPAMI

Let's check the separability of class labels
and **only use well-separated classes** as ground truth clusters

Classes are not Clusters IEEE VIS 2023

Let's check the separability of class labels
and use the **separability itself as ground truth**

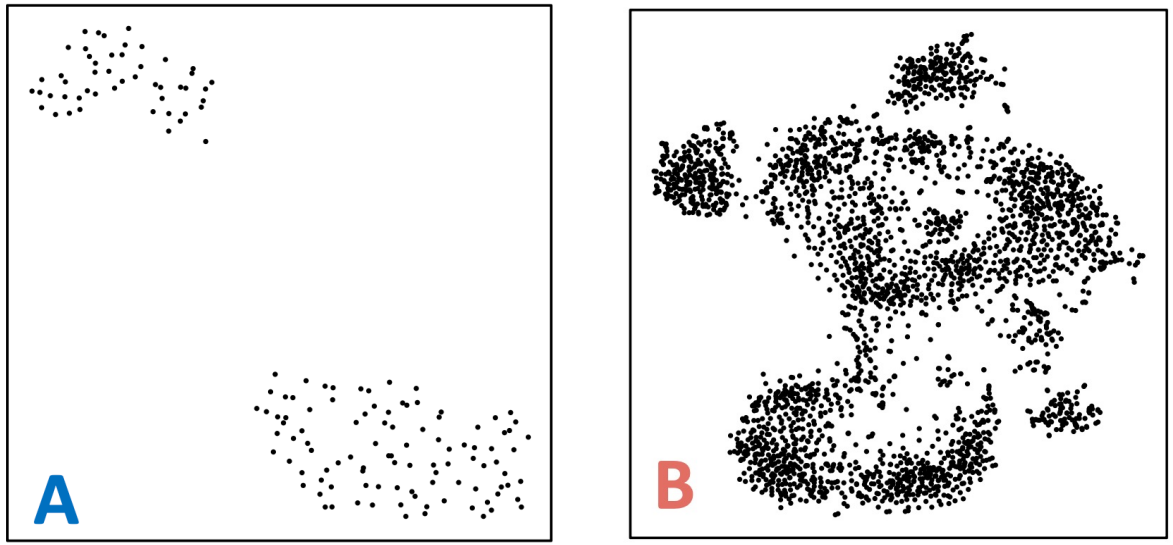


Reliable Interactions

CLAMS IEEE VIS 2023 *Best papers honorable mention (top 5%)*

Inconsistency between analysts can make visual analytics unreliable

Ambiguous visualizations incurs such inconsistency



Clear Ambiguous

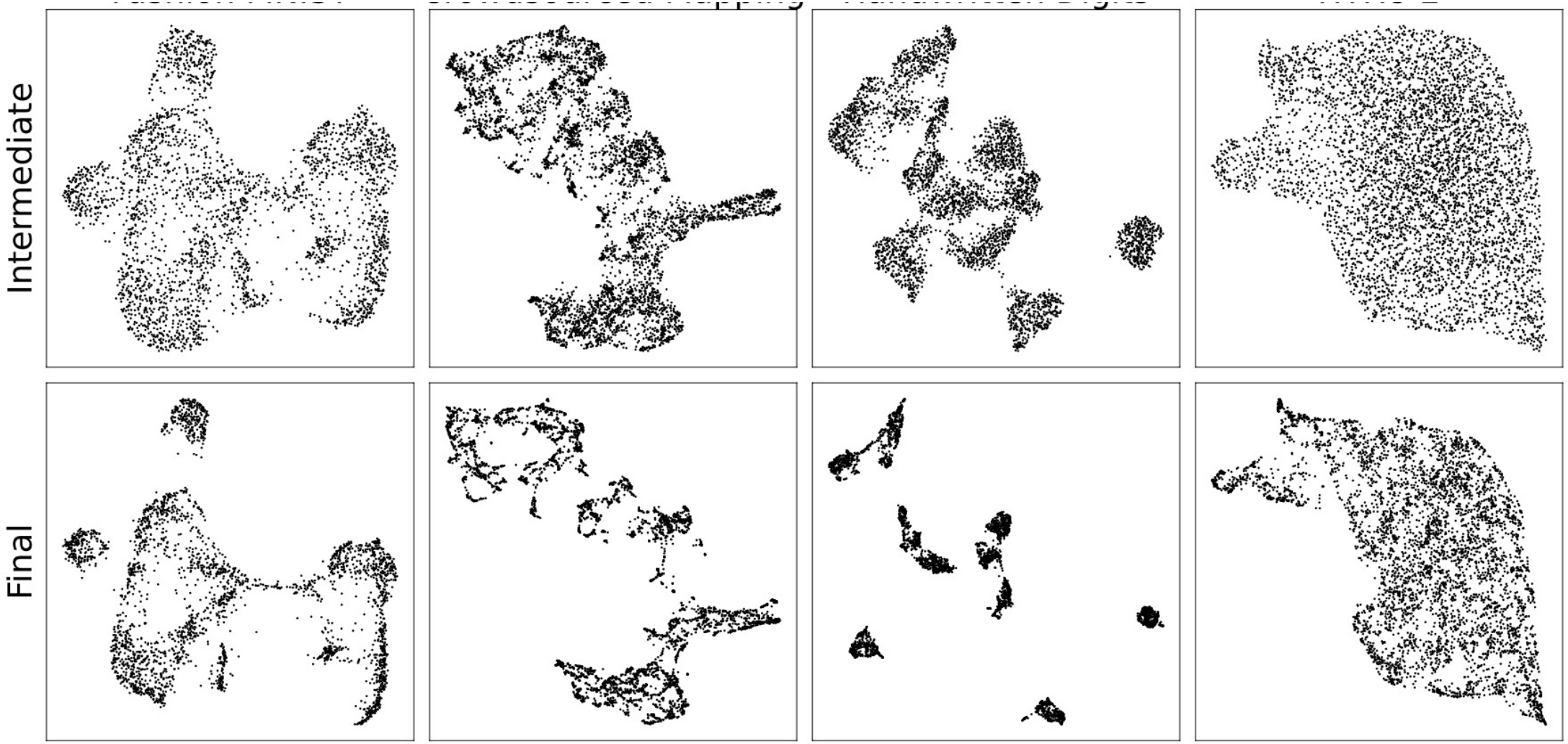
CLAMS IEEE VIS 2023

Inconsistency between analysts can make visual analytics unreliable

Ambiguous visualizations incurs such inconsistency

I designed **CLAMS,** a visual quality metrics that automatically quantifies the ambiguity of monochrome scatterplots

CLAMS + Dimensionality reduction





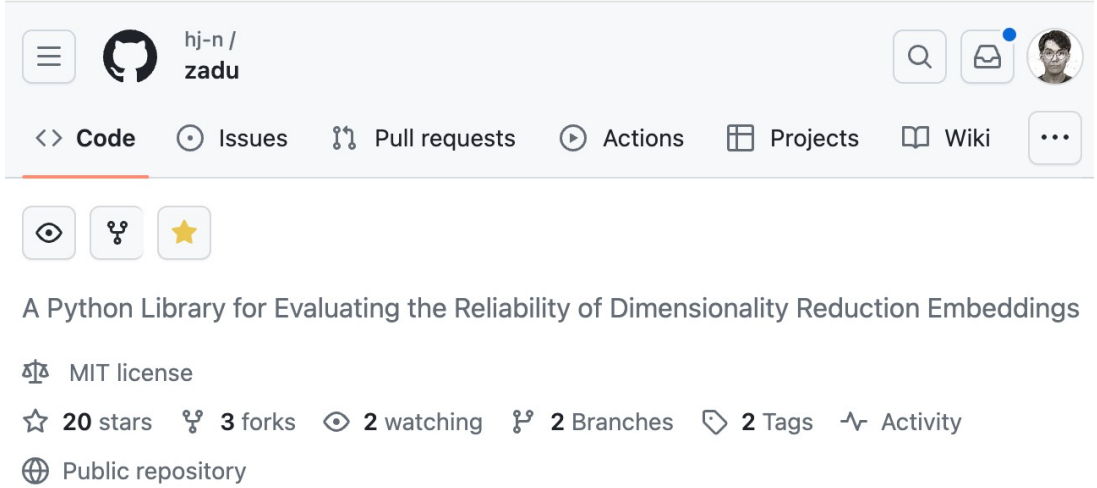
Democratizing the Findings

Making ML application reliable needs **additional effort**

How we can ***democratize our findings?***
How we can make **more practitioners to use ML more reliably?**

ZADU IEEE VIS 2023

Solution 1: Make techniques more accessible




```python
from zadu import zadu

hd, ld = load_datasets()
spec = [{
    "id"    : "tnc",
    "params": { "k": 20 },
}, {
    "id"    : "snc",
    "params": { "k": 30, "clustering_strategy": "dbscan" }
}]

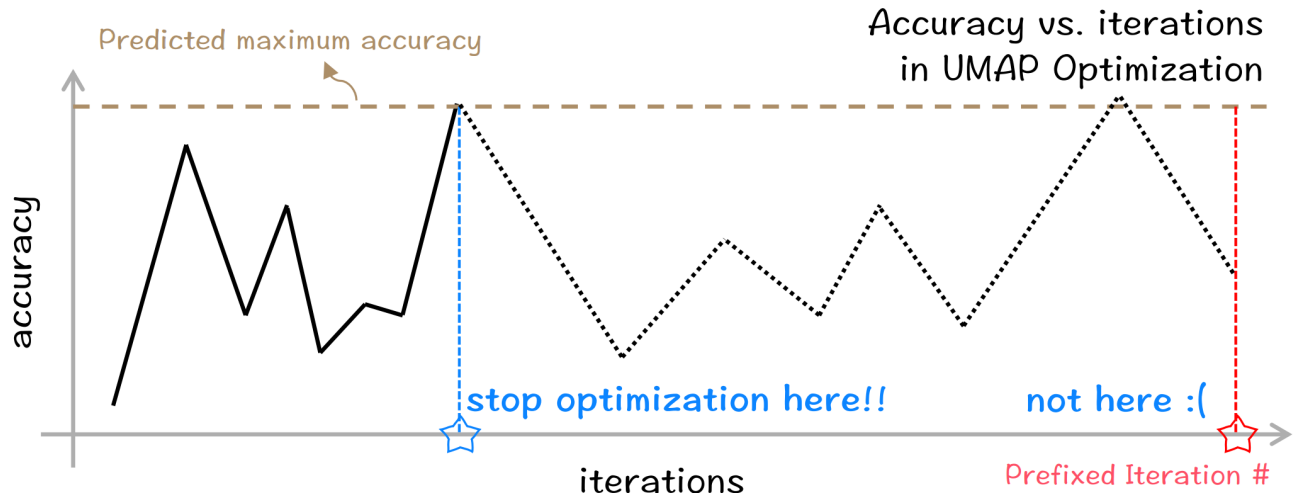
scores = zadu.ZADU(spec, hd).measure(ld)
print("T&C:", scores[0])
print("S&C:", scores[1])
```

ZADU IEEE VIS 2023

Solution 1: Make techniques more accessible

Structural Complexity *under review*, IEEE VIS 2024

Solution 2: Make techniques more efficient



ZADU IEEE VIS 2023

Solution 1: Make techniques more accessible

Structural Complexity *under review*, IEEE VIS 2024

Solution 2: Make techniques more efficient

Future work for dissertation:

Additional Solutions??

Future Projects (Maybe after graduation)

I will identify and tackle the **reliability problems of using foundation models** for HCI and data visualization research

I will identify and tackle the **reliability problems** that may occur in **immersive data analytics** environments (e.g., AR, VR).

I will develop automatic measures that **quantify human subjectivity**

Acknowledgements

Kwon Ko, Jaemin Jo, Youngtaek Kim, Aeri Cho, DongHwa Shin,
Seokhyeon Park, Jeongin Park, Jinhwa Jang, Soohyun Lee,
Jake Hyun, Hyunwook Lee, Dae Hyun Kim, Sungbok Shin,
Yun-Hsin Kuo, Michaël Aupetit, Kwan-Liu Ma,
Ghulam Jilani Quadri, Paul Rosen, Danielle Albers Szafir,
and Jinwook Seo